

Global I/O Smartphones

August '26 Sell-Through: No signs of recovery yet

Global smartphone unit sell-through -8.9% YoY August '26 YTD

Global smartphone unit sell-through (source: Counterpoint) for the month of August '26 came in at 85.9m units (-0.1% MoM, -12.3% YoY), marking the ninth consecutive month of YoY sell-through decline (was -12.2%/-10.9% YoY in July/June). By region, all regions except for the US (-3.4% YoY) saw double-digit YoY declines, with India seeing the most incremental downside at -17.7% YoY, followed by China (-17.3%), Europe (-10.7%) and RoW (-10.1%). Following eight months of significant YoY weakness, August '26 YTD global smartphone unit sell-through now sits at -8.9% YoY with all regions well in negative comps (India/China/Europe/RoW/US: -12.3%/-10.5%/-8.7%/-8.0%/-4.4% YoY).

Apple outperformance continues, Samsung beginning to rebound

Apple: YTD iPhone unit sell-through (149.3m units, +8.7% YoY) continues to highlight the material outperformance of Apple, which remains the only major OEM (>10% unit market share) in positive comps. With key iPhone suppliers optimistic on unit growth in '27 ([link](#)) on the back of (1) the change in launch schedule (3 models each in 1Q27 and 3Q27) and (2) the introduction of iPhone Duo (~10m units in first 12 months), we continue to forecast Apple strength to continue beyond '26 (UBSe sell-in: +8.5% YoY) and into '27 (+4.7% YoY). **Samsung:** August '26 sell-through came in at 20.3m units (+0.9% YoY), returning to positive comps for the first time since March '26, primarily on the back of the release of the new flagship foldable models (Galaxy Z Fold8 Ultra, Fold8, Flip8) released on August 7th. New foldable sales in August came in at 2.8m units, only 0.3m units (or 7.5%) below July+August '25 sales for last year's lineup (Galaxy Z Fold7, Flip7, Flip7 FE; released on July 25th, 2025) despite two less weeks of sales. Whilst YTD sell-through still remains soft at -4.1% YoY, we believe resilient sales of the new flagship model as well as incremental share gains in the mid-range should help Samsung achieve YoY unit growth (UBSe '26E sell-in: +4.4% YoY). **China Android:** We continue to see memory-driven downside materialising with Transsion, Oppo, Vivo, and Xiaomi YoY sell-through decline now at -23.1%/-19.0%/-18.2%/-18.1%.

Reiterating our sell-in forecasts of -10.0%/-3.0% YoY in '26E/'27E

We entered the year with a cautious view on the smartphone industry ([link](#)) primarily on the back of rapidly rising memory costs. We also flagged that these dynamics will be much more penalising for Chinese OEMs focusing on the low-end/mid-range segment. With the DRAM/NAND upcycles likely to extend until at least 2Q28E/4Q27E and unit sell-through now down 8.9% YoY globally (and on average 16.0% for Transsion, Oppo, Vivo, and Xiaomi) eight months into the year, we expect to see double-digit YoY unit decline % and reiterate our '26E sell-in forecast of -10.0% YoY. Heading into '27, with memory likely to remain an incremental headwind, we expect to see muted demand for smartphones and see units declining further from a low base. We recently lowered our YoY unit sell-in forecasts for '27E to -3.0% from +2.0% ([link](#)).

Selective on smartphone plays; prefer memory/MLCC suppliers

Within the smartphone supply chain, we continue to prefer MediaTek and Samsung (both APAC Key Call Buy) as well as ASE, Hon Hai, JCET, Micron, Murata, SEMCO, SK Hynix and TSMC (all Buy). We remain cautious on LG Display, Maxscend, Xiaomi (all Neutral) and Largan (Sell). We have Neutral ratings on OEMs Apple and Transsion.

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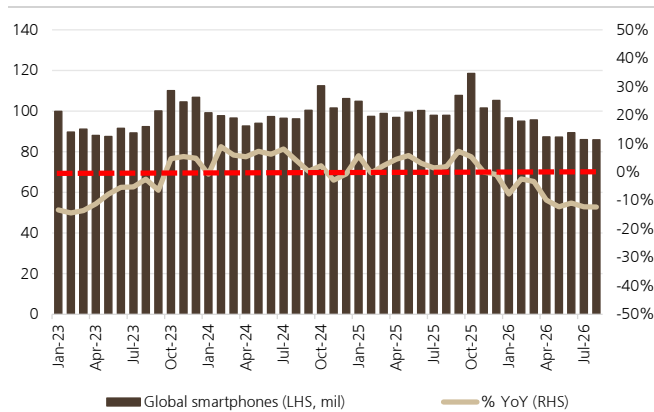
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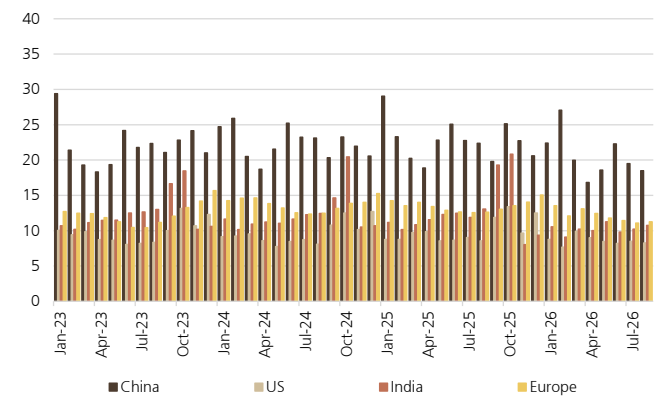
Smartphone units sell-through by markets

Figure 1: Global smartphone monthly unit sell-through



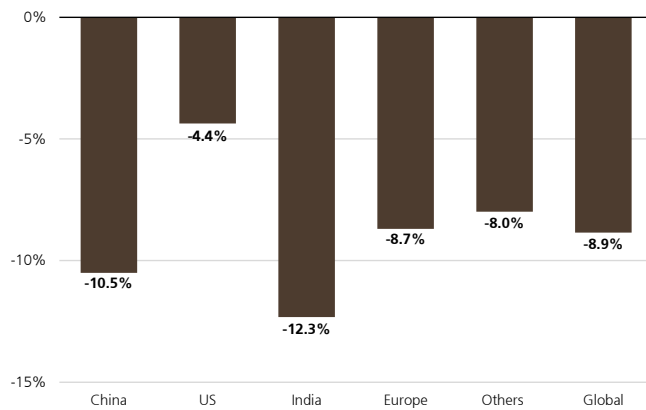
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 2: Smartphone monthly unit sell-through breakdown by markets (m units)



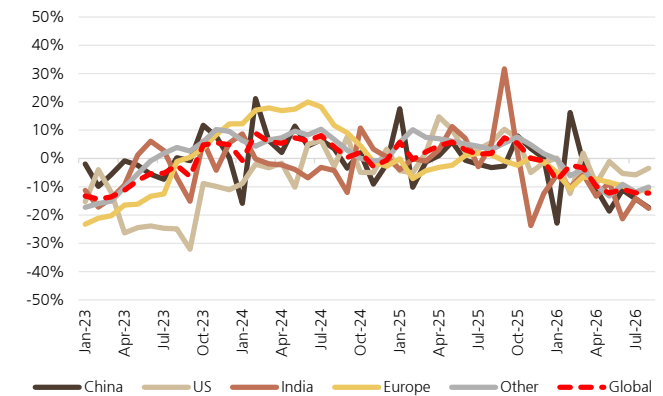
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 3: YoY smartphone unit sell-through growth by region (August '26 YTD)



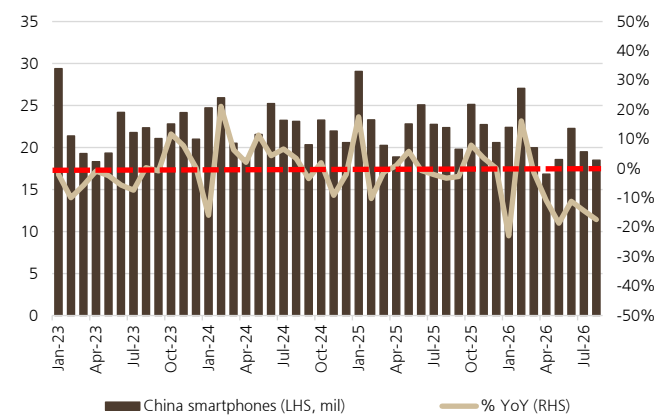
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 4: YoY smartphone unit sell-through growth by region (monthly)



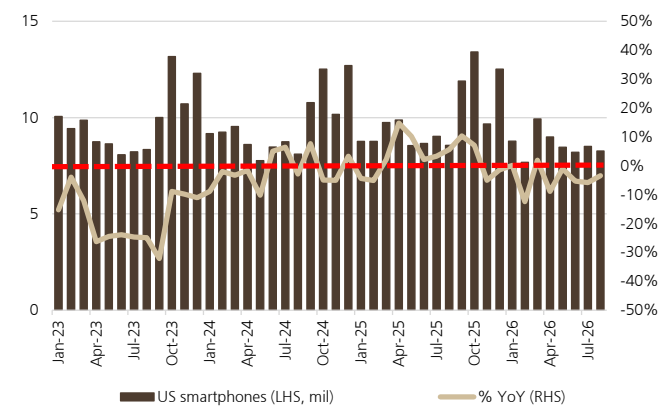
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 5: China smartphone monthly unit sell-through



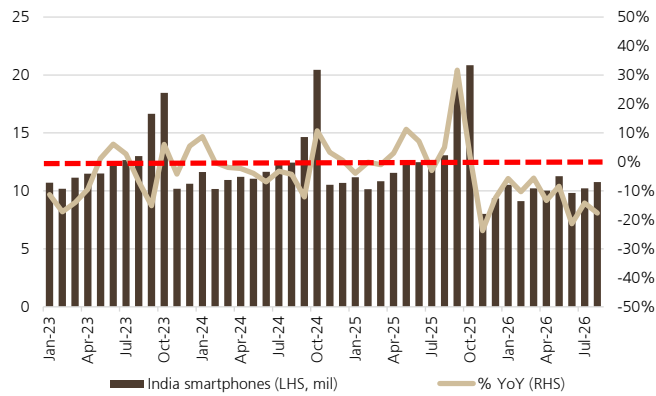
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 6: US smartphone monthly unit sell-through



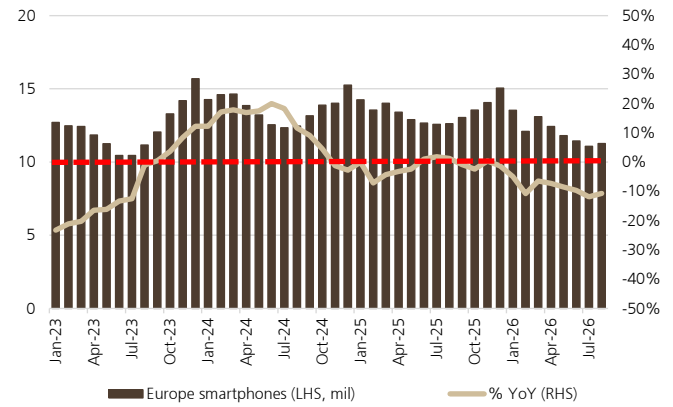
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 7: India smartphone monthly unit sell-through



Source: Counterpoint, UBS

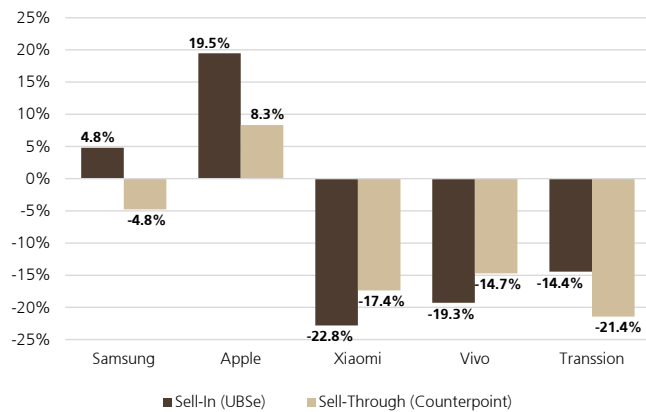
Figure 8: Europe smartphone monthly unit sell-through



Source: Counterpoint, UBS

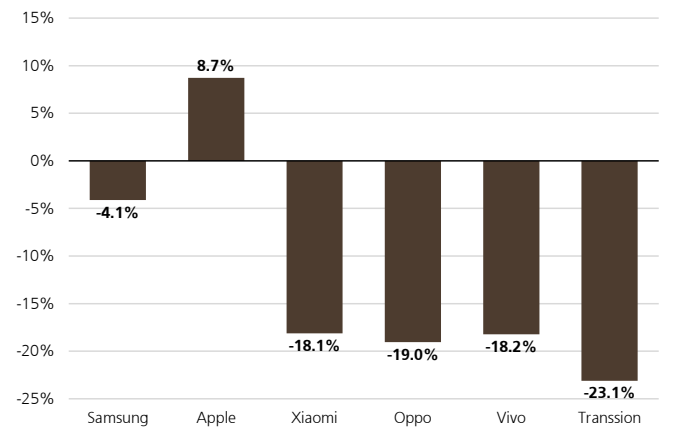
Smartphone units sell-through by OEMs

Figure 9: YoY smartphone unit sell-in vs sell-through growth by OEM (1H26)



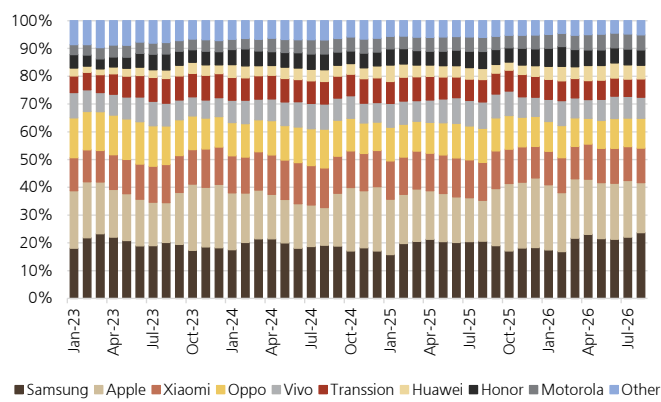
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 10: YoY smartphone unit sell-through growth by OEM (August '26 YTD)



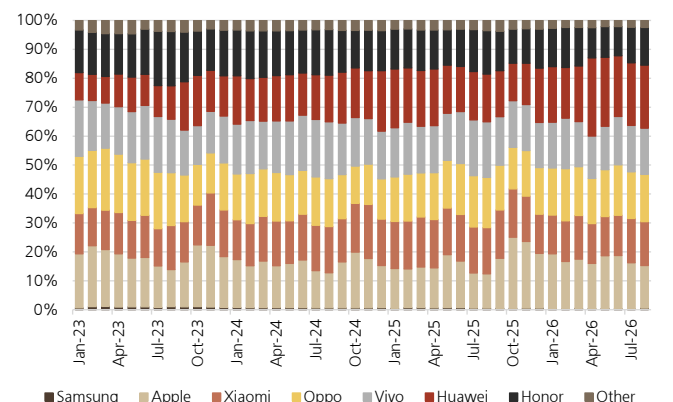
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 11: Global smartphone unit sell-through market share by OEMs



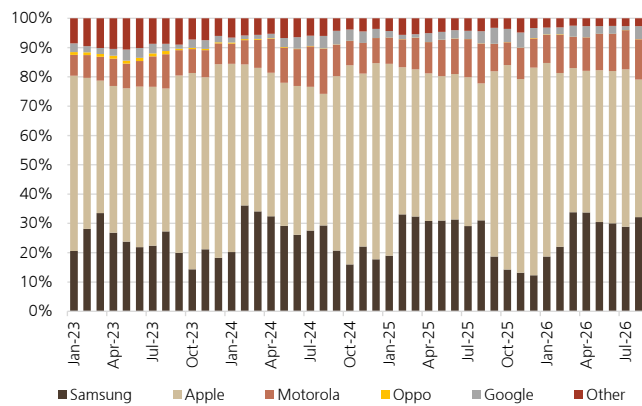
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 12: China smartphone unit sell-through market share by OEMs



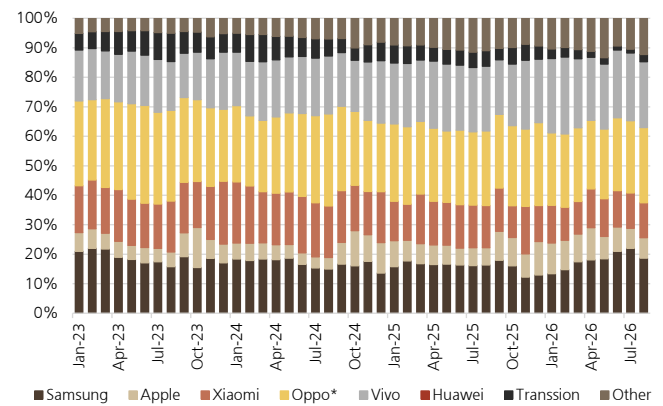
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 13: US smartphone unit sell-through market share by OEMs



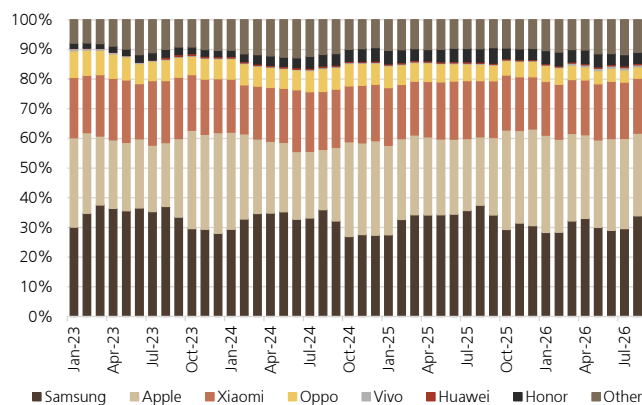
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 14: India smartphone unit sell-through market share by OEMs



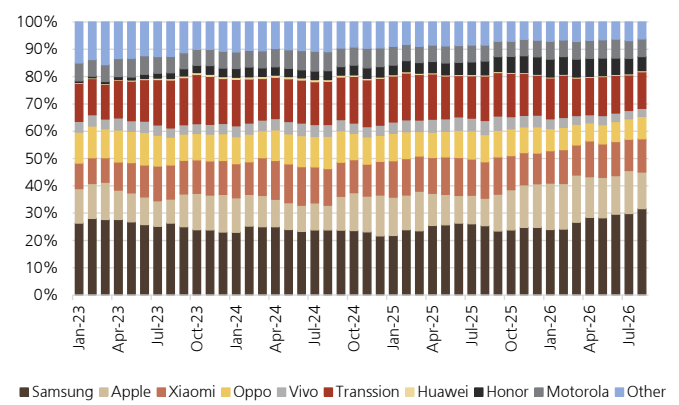
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 15: Europe smartphone unit sell-through by OEMs



Source: Counterpoint, UBS

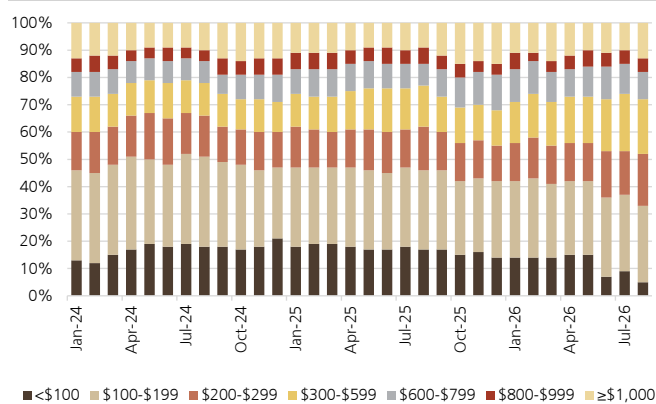
Figure 16: RoW smartphone unit sell-through market share by OEMs



Source: Counterpoint, UBS

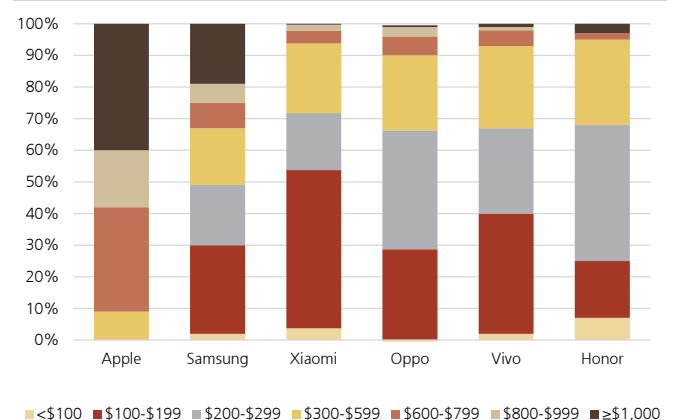
Smartphone units sell-through by segment

Figure 17: Global smartphone unit sell-through by price band



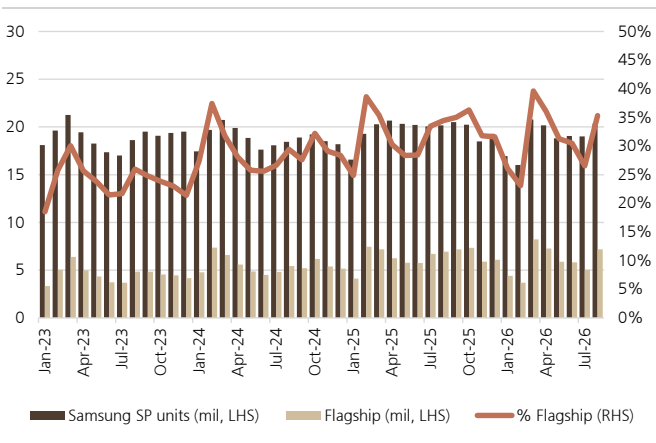
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 18: OEM smartphone unit sell-through mix by price band (August '26)



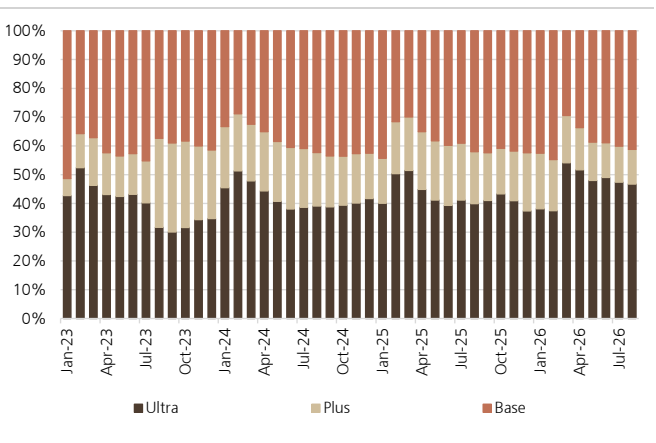
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 19: Samsung smartphone unit sell-through and flagship as % of total



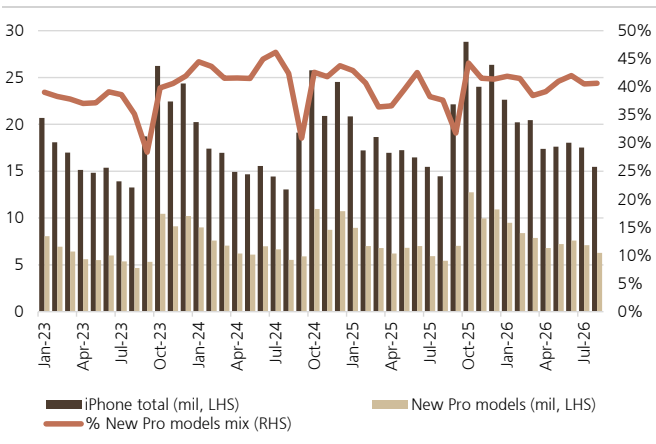
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 20: Samsung Galaxy S series unit sell-through product mix



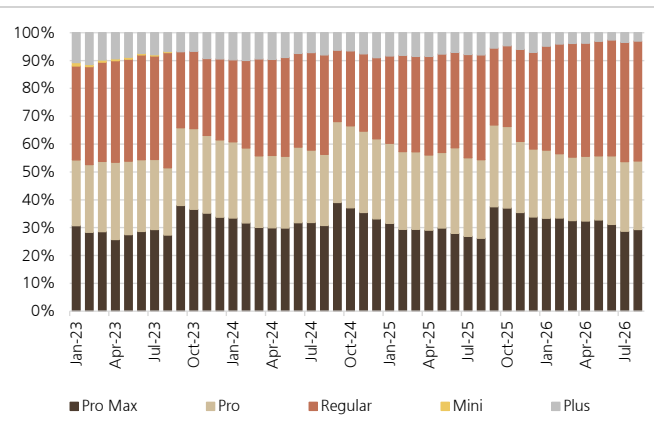
Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 21: iPhone unit sell-through and new Pro models as % of total



Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Figure 22: iPhone series new models unit sell-through product mix



Source: Counterpoint, UBS

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

The handset industry, as part of consumer electronics, is cyclically sensitive to the economy and so upside and downside risks relate to macro drivers. Other downside risks include the rapid loss of market share due to poor product timing, design or distribution. The supply chain companies into the handset industry also operate in a highly cyclical market both from macro concerns and inventory cycles within the supply chain. These companies also operate in a highly competitive environment with product innovation and R&D investments critical to success. Valuation methods across the sector include multiple analysis.

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Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 September 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

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Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
ASE Industrial ^{28,16b}	3711.TW	Buy	NT\$713.00	02 Oct 2026
Apple Inc. ^{28,7,6a,16b}	AAPL.O	Neutral	US\$333.69	02 Oct 2026
Hon Hai Precision ^{4,5,28,6b}	2317.TW	Buy	NT\$251.00	02 Oct 2026
JCET Group	600584.SS	Buy	Rmb64.28	30 Sep 2026
LG Display ^{16b}	034220.KS	Neutral	Won8,570	02 Oct 2026
Largan Precision ²⁸	3008.TW	Sell	NT\$6,290	02 Oct 2026
Maxscend Microelectronics	300782.SZ	Neutral	Rmb70.17	30 Sep 2026
MediaTek Inc. ²⁸	2454.TW	Buy	NT\$4,950	02 Oct 2026
Micron Technology Inc. ^{28,16b}	MU.O	Buy	US\$1,074.89	02 Oct 2026
Murata Manufacturing ²⁸	6981.T	Buy	¥8,467	02 Oct 2026
SK Hynix ^{28,8,16b}	000660.KS	Buy	Won1,841,000	02 Oct 2026
Samsung Electro-Mechanics ²⁸	009150.KS	Buy	Won1,581,000	02 Oct 2026
Samsung Electronics ^{2,28,8,6b}	005930.KS	Buy	Won276,000	02 Oct 2026
Shenzhen Transsion Holdings	688036.SS	Neutral	Rmb53.80	30 Sep 2026
Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing ^{16b}	2330.TW	Buy	NT\$2,500	02 Oct 2026
Xiaomi ^{28,16a}	1810.HK	Neutral	HK\$24.24	02 Oct 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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